

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Group ‘rolling the dice’ on remapping

Ex-Obama officials push to stop lawmakers from directly drawing their own district boundaries

By Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

The departure of Texas Democrats who spent two weeks in suburban Chicago evading a vote in their state on a Republican-backed redrawing of congressional district boundaries has not ended the conversation on partisan gerrymandering in Illinois.

A bipartisan pair of former high-level officials from President Barack Obama’s administration on Tuesday began their public push to stop state lawmakers from directly drawing their own district boundaries, a change they argue would mean more competitive elections and a General Assembly that better represents the will of the voters. The “Fair Maps Illinois”

proposal marks the third attempt since 2014 to reduce heavy partisan influence in how Illinois district boundaries are drawn following the once-per-decade census. Supporters argue the latest effort, which requires amending the state constitution, will be tailored to fit the narrow frame the Illinois Supreme Court has outlined for citizen-driven amendments after legal challenges struck down similar proposals in 2014 and 2016. The group — being led by Chicago Democrat William Daley,

Obama’s former chief of staff, and Peoria Republican Ray LaHood, Obama’s former transportation secretary — made its announcement just one day after Texas lawmakers headed home after their legislative walkout temporarily prevented the Texas GOP from jamming through a congressional remap and elevated gerrymandering as a national issue. The Fair Maps Illinois effort wouldn’t affect the drawing of congressional maps and is focused just on the process of drawing

district boundaries for the state House and Senate. Still, that issue has created substantial pushback statewide in the past, and backers acknowledge they once again anticipate having to fend off legal challenges. During a Tuesday morning panel discussion hosted by the Lincoln Forum at the Union League Club of Chicago, LaHood said they are “rolling the dice here” on how the 5-2 Democratic-majority state

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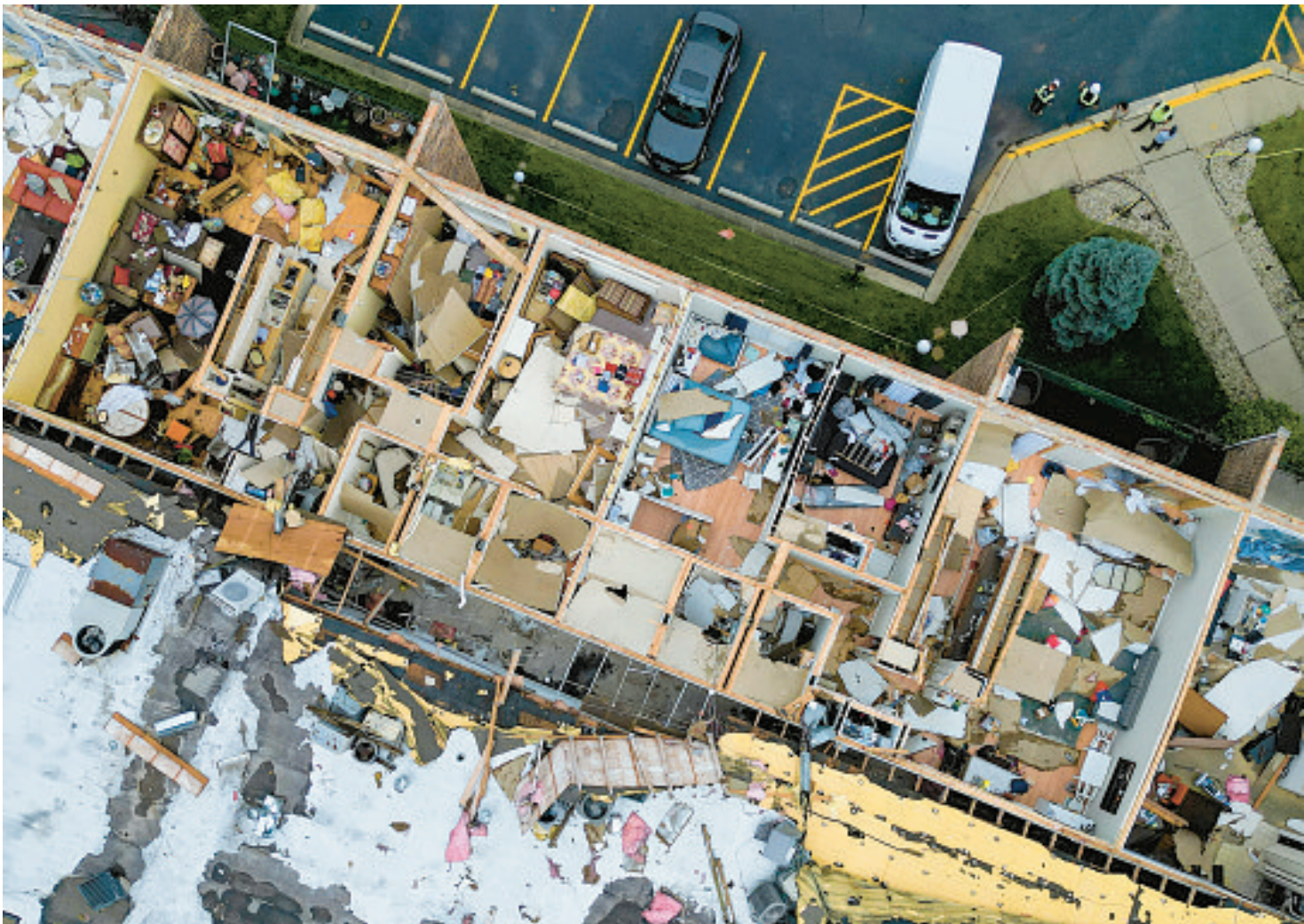
Trump: No US troops to Ukraine

Stance comes day after not ruling out peacekeeping role

By Darlene Superville and Aamer Madhani
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump on Tuesday offered his assurances that U.S. troops would not be sent to help defend Ukraine against Russia after seeming to leave open the possibility the day before. Trump also said in a morning TV interview that Ukraine’s hopes of joining NATO and regaining the Crimean Peninsula from Russia are “impossible.” The Republican president, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and other European leaders held talks at the White House on Monday aimed at ending Russia’s war against Ukraine. While answering questions from journalists, Trump did not rule out sending U.S. troops to participate in a European-led effort to defend Ukraine as part of security guarantees sought by Zelenskyy. Trump said after his meeting in Alaska last week with Russian President Vladimir Putin that Putin was open to the idea of security guarantees for Ukraine. But asked Tuesday on Fox News Channel’s “Fox & Friends” what assurances Trump could provide going forward and beyond his term that American troops would not be part of defending Ukraine’s border, Trump said, “Well, you have my assurance, and I’m president.” Trump would have no control over the U.S. military after his terms ends in January 2029. White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt later on Tuesday emphasized that “U.S. boots will not be on the ground” as part of any potential peacekeeping mission. The president also said in the interview that he is optimistic that a deal can be reached to end

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Workers stand in a parking lot and assess the damage after a weekend storm tore the roof off of a Mount Prospect condominium building on Tuesday. From overhead, beds, clothing and personal items can be seen strewn about the rooms. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

City and suburbs cleaning up after rounds of heavy storms

By Rebecca Johnson, William Tong, Jake Sheridan and Paulina Czupryna
Chicago Tribune

When the rain comes, Sharen Renee Parish sits on her basement steps and waits for the water to mop up mud, a tall task for the disabled Chicago Transit Authority retiree who needs a caregiver. It worked as heavy rains fell Monday night. But in the storms over the weekend, the water just kept coming, rising past her knees. “I’m not even supposed to be in the basement trying to do this, but I have no one to assist me. No one whatsoever,” Parish said.

UPCOMING FORECAST

Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
High 77 Low 65	High 77 Low 64	High 82 Low 67	High 82 Low 59

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

The 61-year-old caught the attention of Mayor Brandon Johnson on Tuesday morning as he walked through the Gage Park neighborhood, flanked by a number of top city officials tasked with overseeing sewers, streets and emergencies, leaving buckets of cleaning supplies — disinfectant, dust masks, mop heads and more — on doorsteps and in overstretched hands. A devastated Parish told the mayor that her purple-and-white sided home — now with a broken boiler and a furnace fixed after July flooding broken again — is her one shot at leaving generational wealth for her granddaughter.

“All my efforts are fruitless,” she said. “I’ve called everyone and I can’t get any assistance.” “Well, we’re here,” the mayor responded. “We don’t control the rain. The infrastructure in our city has been in need of repair for a very long time. We’re committed to that repair. We need your help and support, because these repairs do require investments. We are living in a time in which people want me to cut the budget.” From the flooded basements on the city’s Southwest Side to a flooded riverwalk in Naperville, thousands across Chicago and the suburbs were affected

Turn to Storms, Page 4

Terrible artist draws terrible portraits — and finds a niche

By Christopher Borrelli
Chicago Tribune

Jacob Ryan Reno, long and boyish, wearing the kind of blue smock you imagine a painter would wear in a cartoon about a painter, is not good at his job. He draws and has become pretty popular in Chicago for those drawings. Yet ... *he’s so bad at it*. So bad he inspires a perverse confidence in that lack of talent, partly because he warns everyone with a sheepish smile that he’s not very good. When I asked a woman in Logan Square why she was waiting for Reno to draw her portrait, despite knowing his skills were questionable, she replied, with irony: “He must be talented if there’s a line.” She added, “I mean, what if he becomes famous someday?” Then she mentioned, even more straight-faced this time, that she was an “art enthusiast.” And Reno, for sure, is an artist,



Amanda Sands, left, and Francesca Sands laugh as they look at the portrait Jacob Ryan Reno drew of them on Aug. 10 in Logan Square. Reno draws “terrible” portraits of people for \$5. **EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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INSIDE

Slumping slugger looks for answers

The Cubs’ Kyle Tucker sits out doubleheader with Brewers for a mental reset. Owen Caissie starts and played a big role in the Cubs’ 6-4 win in Game 1. **Chicago Sports**

Where to visit on a culinary road trip

From community burger nights to multicourse meals, a look at five of the best farm dinners that are worth traveling for — plus where to post up, post-meal. **Food & Health**

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